P250/1
GEOGRAPHY
Paper 1
Aug, 2026
3 hours

MATIGO EXAMINATIONS BOARD

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

GEOGRAPHY

Paper 1

(Physical Geography)

3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

This examination paper consists of two sections; **A** *and* **B**. *It has four items. Section* **A** *has two* **compulsory** *items.*

Section **B** *has two optional items; Respond to* **one** *item.*

Respond to **three** *items in all.*

You may use diagrams where applicable to illustrate your responses.

Any additional item(s) responded to will not be scored.

Responses to each item must start on a new page.

©2026 Matigo Examinations Board

SECTION A

All *items in this section are* **compulsory**.

Item 1

During a Geography lesson, the Senior Five students of Nkondo SSS studied the topic Drainage, particularly the subtopic Role of Rivers in Shaping the Landscape. Since they had already planned a Geography field excursion, they considered this topic ideal for field study. They therefore consulted their Geography teachers and some Senior Six students for guidance.

The Geography teachers selected Kiboga as the study area because the students wanted an area with a wide variety of drainage features, relief, vegetation, and human activities that would enrich learning in different aspects of physical and human geography.

On the scheduled day, the students travelled to the study area. They were each provided with the map extract of Kiboga Sheet 59/2, 3-U.S.D. and agreed to divide themselves into four groups to make data collection easier.

The first group entered from the south-western part of the area and came across River Kinoga. The second group entered from the south and encountered River Kyekumbya. The third group entered from the north-west and came across River Nakayenga. The fourth group entered from the north-east and encountered a magnificent unnamed river flowing sluggishly over a gentle gradient. Along this river, they observed several interesting landforms. Some had concave and convex shapes, others resembled a horse's shoe, while a number of them could not be accurately identified or described.

After regrouping, all the students discussed the features they had observed along the different river profiles. However, the fourth group was unable to correctly identify and describe the landforms they had observed along the unnamed river. They also agreed that these rivers posed several challenges to the local communities, but they could not explain how the communities could mitigate these challenges.

The students have therefore approached you, as a Senior Six student who has studied this topic, to help them identify the river landforms observed by the fourth group and explain how the local communities can mitigate the challenges associated with rivers.

Task

(a) Using any suitable illustration locate the features that were seen by all 4 groups.
(b) Give an account of the role of rivers in shaping the landscape seen by group members who entered from North East.
(c) How best can natives sustainably utilize these rivers?

Item 2

Kijana Valley is a densely populated region located near the boundary of two tectonic plates. The valley contains several towns, farms, factories, schools, and a major hydroelectric dam. For many years, geologists have warned that the area is vulnerable to seismic activity because of the presence of a major fault line running through the region.

On the morning of **15th June 2026**, residents of Kijana Valley experienced a **magnitude 7.2 earthquake**. The earthquake occurred at a shallow depth of **12 km**, with its epicentre located approximately **20 km east of the town of Luwanda**. The ground shaking lasted for nearly **50 seconds**, causing widespread panic and destruction. Several buildings collapsed, particularly older structures that had not been designed to withstand seismic activity. Roads and bridges were damaged, making it difficult for emergency services to reach the affected communities. Landslides blocked mountain roads, while cracks appeared in agricultural land. The hydroelectric dam also developed minor structural cracks, raising concerns about the safety of nearby settlements.

Thousands of people were displaced, and many families lost access to clean water, electricity, and medical services. Schools and hospitals were temporarily closed. In the weeks that followed, a series of aftershocks continued to affect the region, increasing fear among residents and complicating recovery efforts.

Government authorities, humanitarian organisations, and local communities have begun planning both immediate relief measures and long-term disaster management strategies. Scientists are also studying the event to better understand the tectonic processes responsible for the earthquake.

As a geologist living in the affected area, you have been asked to advise the local authorities and communities on the causes of the earthquake, its impacts, and appropriate measures to reduce the effects of future seismic events.

Tasks:
(a)Account for the occurrence of the above catastrophe in kijana valley
(b)Explain ways of mitigating the above catastrophe.

SECTION B

Respond to only **one** *item from this section.*

Item 3

Climate change in Uganda is no longer just a future concern; it is a pressing challenge that is already having profound socio-economic and political impacts. Ranked the **14th most vulnerable country** on the **ND-GAIN Index**, Uganda faces severe climate-related impacts that are worsened by widespread poverty and an overreliance on climate-sensitive sectors such as agriculture. The Rwenzori sub-region, in particular, is highly vulnerable, with young people among the most affected.

Erratic rainfall, floods, and prolonged droughts have greatly disrupted traditional agricultural practices, resulting in reduced crop yields, declining household incomes, food insecurity, and increased unemployment among the youth. These challenges have also contributed to environmental degradation, resource-based conflicts, and increased vulnerability to climate-related disasters.

The situation calls for urgent, comprehensive, youth-centred strategies to address the interconnected challenges of climate change, environmental degradation, conflict, and socio-economic instability. Implementing appropriate adaptation and mitigation measures can strengthen resilience, reduce vulnerability, and promote sustainable development in Uganda.

A climate change debate has been organised in your district, and you have been invited to participate as a climatologist.

Task.

Make a presentation in your speech talk about the causes of extreme weather conditions and ways of mitigating them.

Item 4.

Uganda and the rest of East Africa experience varying weather and climatic conditions throughout the year due to the movement and interaction of different air masses. These include the moist maritime air masses from the Indian Ocean, the dry continental air masses from the north-east, and the moist equatorial air masses associated with the **Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ)**. The characteristics of these air masses greatly influence rainfall distribution, temperature, humidity, cloud cover, wind patterns, and the occurrence of weather hazards such as droughts, floods, and thunderstorms.

In recent years, farmers in western Uganda have reported increased crop yields during seasons dominated by moist air masses, while pastoralists in north-eastern Uganda have experienced severe water shortages and pasture scarcity due to the prolonged influence of dry continental air masses. Urban centres have also experienced flooding following intense rainfall associated with moist maritime air masses.

In response to these changing weather patterns and their impacts on livelihoods, the Government of Uganda is sponsoring meteorologists to conduct further research on the characteristics and effects of air masses. You have been selected to represent your school at a meteorological conference organised by your district, where you are expected to explain how different air masses influence the weather and climate of Uganda and East Africa.

Task

Make a report that you will use to present at the conference .in your report consider the characteristics of three major air masses and their influence on climate of Uganda.

END